Write Up

DEADFACE CTF



vrndr4

Miscellaneous

[0 pts] AI Rule

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI)
The use of AI agents, autonomous AI tools, or automated AI-driven systems to independently solve challenges is strictly prohibited during DEADFACE CTF 2026. All challenges are intended to test the knowledge, skills, and problem-solving abilities of human competitors.

Players may use AI-powered tools for general research, learning, troubleshooting, or guidance. However, submitting flags or solutions obtained primarily through AI-generated work, rather than the competitor's own efforts, is prohibited. AI must never be used to interact with the scoring server or infrastructure.

If DEADFACE CTF Staff discovers or receives credible evidence that a competitor or team used AI to autonomously solve challenges, the competitor or team may be disqualified from the competition, removed from the leaderboard, and deemed ineligible for prizes or awards.

DEADFACE CTF Staff reserves the right to investigate suspected violations and make final decisions regarding enforcement and disqualification.

Submit the flag as deadface{i_agree}

Flag

deadface{i_agree}

[1 pts] Starter

Welcome to DEADFACE CTF 2026! We're excited to have you

here. This year, you'll be working for a (fictional) organization called Zero Trace. Your mission is to investigate DEADFACE incidents and beat them at their own game! Please watch this quick intro video - it will introduce you to the event and provide you with much-needed information.

Watch on YouTube

Submit the flag: deadface{th1s_1s_4n_ex4mpl3_fl4g}

Flag

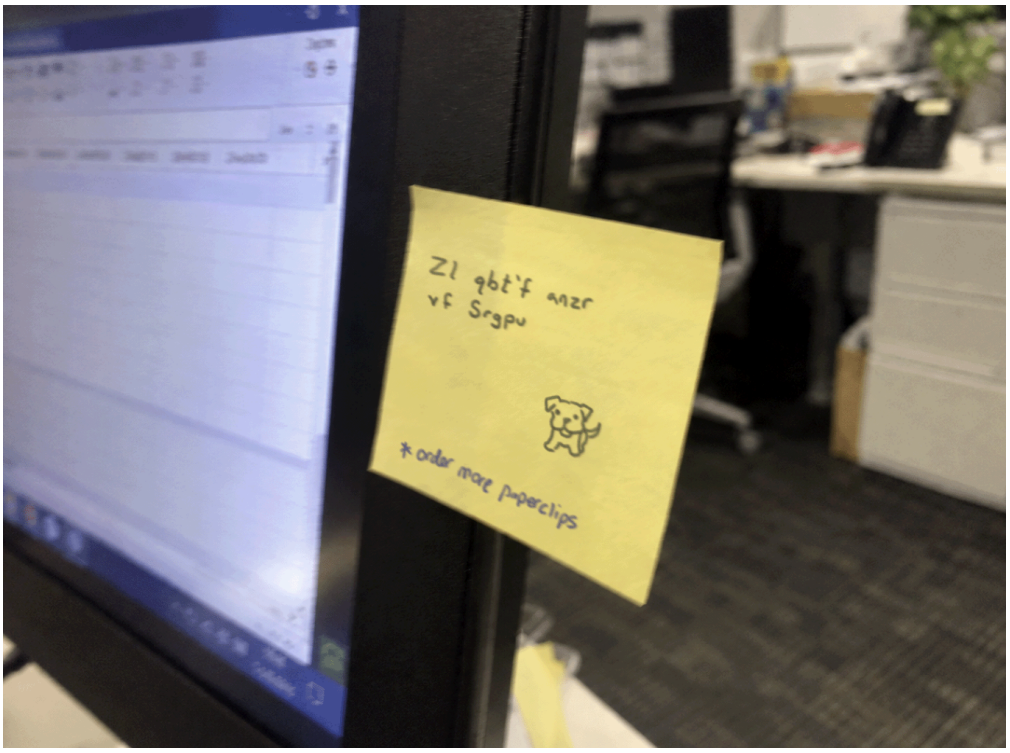
deadface{th1s_1s_4n_ex4mpl3_fl4g}

Cryptography

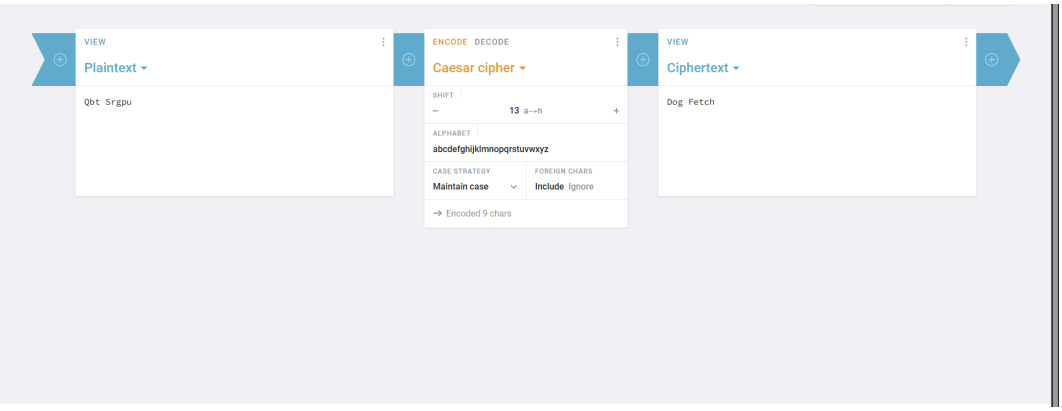
[5 pts] Hail Caesar

One of the faculty at Night Veil University thought it would be clever to write sensitive information on notes by their computer. This sensitive information includes a very easy-to-decipher password hint. Judging by the drawing of a dog on the photo, we assume the password hint is the name of the individual's dog.

Given a picture of a monitor with a sticky note



This one was pretty easy. I figured the code out without having to decode it just by looking at it. I assumed it said My dog's name is ___ and I was right. I put Srgpu in the Caesar Cipher decoder and “Fetch” came out.



Flag

deadface{Fetch}

[25 pts] DECODE-DLE

One of the junior DEADFACE members left a number puzzle to decipher a 3-digit number combination. Do you have the skills to solve the puzzle and open the lock? Follow the clues to decipher the 3-digit code needed to "pick" the lock. Enter the code as 3 digits, no spaces or other separating characters.

I've seen things like this a lot, just never on CTFs.

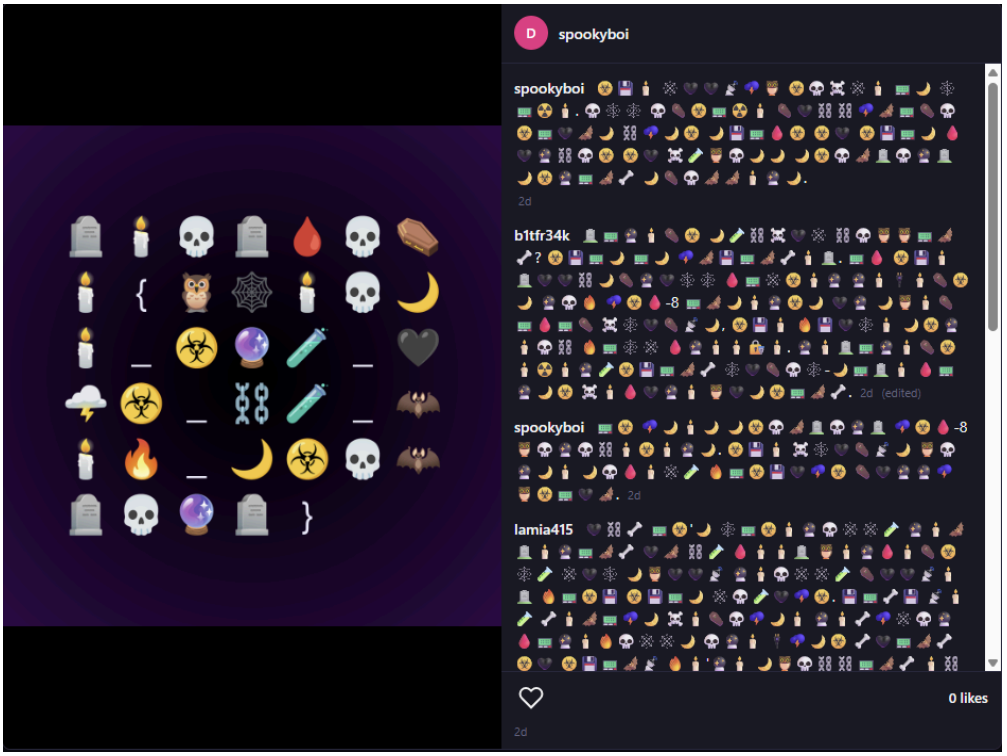
8	6	3	One number is correct but in the wrong place
2	5	0	Nothing is correct
1	6	8	Two numbers are correct but in the wrong place
7	3	5	One number is correct and in the right place
6	8	7	Two numbers are correct but in the wrong place

No way the numbers are 2, 5, and 0. Looking at that I immediately thought 3 was correct, looking at line 1 and 4 but it was just a guess. I was pretty sure 7 was correct because line 4 and line 5 matched up. So the first thought was 7 as the first number. Next guess was 8 and I thought 8 was right, looking at line 1, 3, and 5, but when submitting the flags, I kept getting the wrong answer. So I looked at 6 and put it as the last number because it couldn’t be the first and the second, looking at line 1, 3, and 5. So 7_6. I eliminated 8 and looked at line 3 where 2 numbers are right, just in the wrong place. So I put in 1 in the middle and the flag was captured.

Flag
deadface{716}

[50 pts] Infrequent Emojis
While DoomScrolling, our intel team came across a weird coded post with emojis all over it. One of our experts claims that the patterns point to it still being English but we don't know what it means! Can you figure it out?

Looking at the Doomscroll platform, I stumbled upon a post that is full of emojis (I had to scroll a lot to get to the post).



It is clear that the image is showing the flag because of the {}_, so I know that the emojis before { represent Deadface. With d, e, a, f, and c as the only known letters so far: deadface{--ea-e_---_---_--_-e-_--a-da-d}

The first word is likely to be please, so owl is p, web is l, moon is s. With that I just completed the emojis (and asked help to figure out what the words might be as my vocab is pretty narrow)

Flag

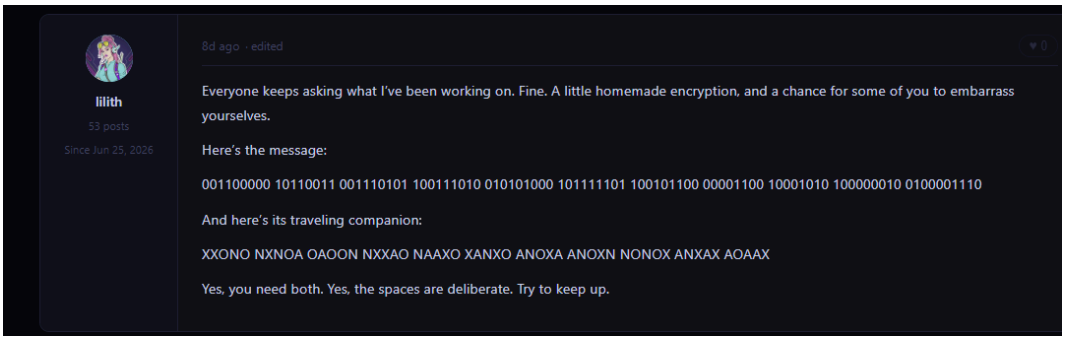
deadface{please_try_out_my_new_standard}

[100 pts] Digital Design

Investigators found a post by lilith on Ghosttown that looks like some new crazy encryption scheme but they can't make heads or tails of it. Find the post with a large binary string and an alphabetic string that

contains the letters A, O, N, and X and see if you can break the code.

Honestly, it was pretty tough for me so I had to look up what this might mean.



Turns out it's a binary code and the XOAN is XOR, OR, AND, and NOT.

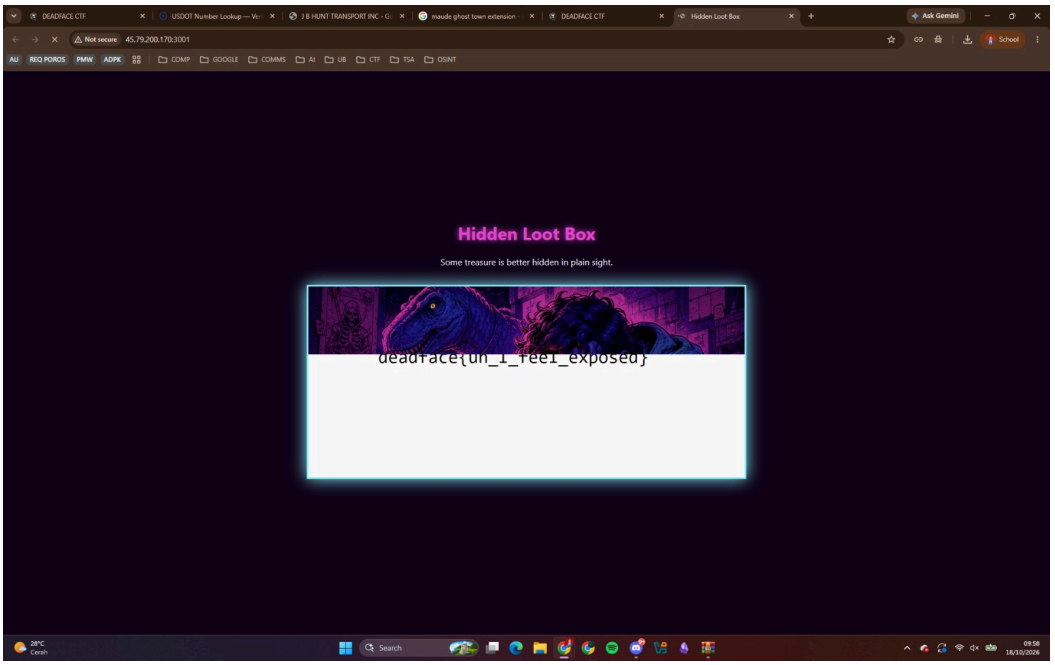
For every part of the binary and the XOAN:
001100000
XXONO
This equals to B

Flag
deadface{BINARYLOGIC}

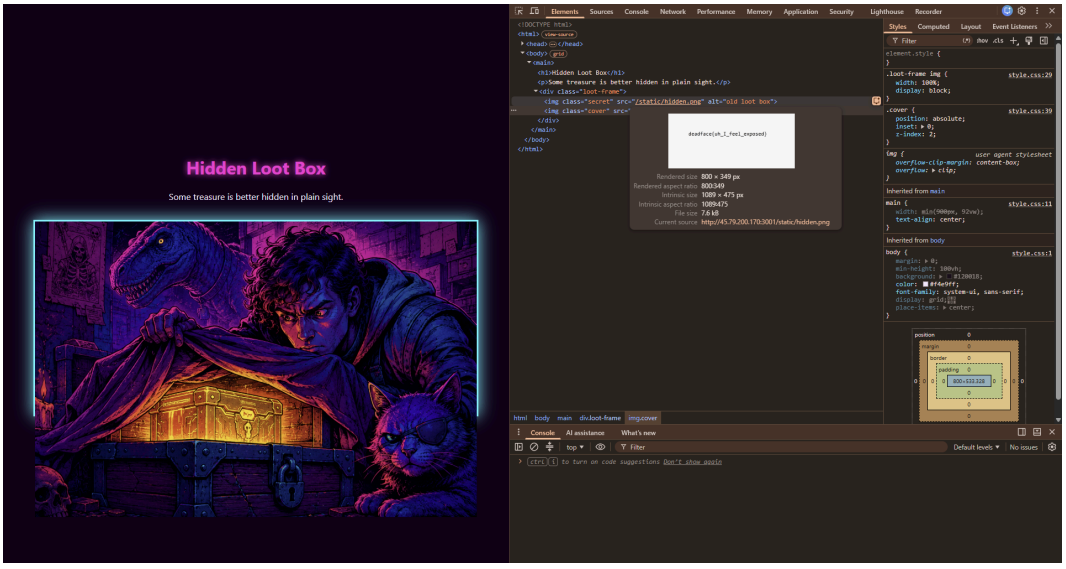
Steganography

[15 pts] Hidden Loot Box
Never judge a book by its cover. Think you can discover this secret?

Pretty self explanatory



I think it was pretty slow so I can see the flag before the image even covered it, but when I inspected the web it also shows this:



Flag

deadface{uh_I_feel_exposed}

[10 pts] Headshot
by @syyntax
DEADFACE was able to compromise a fileshare that consisted of corporate headshots for Aurora Health employees. We believe they're tagging the photos with information that communicates to their group which employees to target in their future campaigns. Figure out which image DEADFACE tampered with - it will give us a heads up on who they plan to target. Submit the answer as deadface{flag_text}.

Given a zip file with 4 files containing 3 openable images and 1 other file.

First thing I did was check strings on the unopenable file and it showed nothing. So I did exiftool on the other images and found the flag

```
andra@LAPTOP-S4SA7HCK:/mnt/c/users/andra/downloads/headshot (1)$ exiftool headshot003.png
ExifTool Version Number         : 12.76
File Name                       : headshot003.png
Directory                       : .
File Size                       : 183 kB
File Modification Date/Time     : 2026:10:18 11:06:04+07:00
File Access Date/Time           : 2026:10:18 11:07:26+07:00
File Inode Change Date/Time     : 2026:10:18 11:06:04+07:00
File Permissions                : -rwxrwxrwx
File Type                       : PNG
File Type Extension             : png
MIME Type                       : image/png
Image Width                     : 512
Image Height                    : 512
Bit Depth                       : 8
Color Type                      : Palette
Compression                     : Deflate/Inflate
Filter                          : Adaptive
Interlace                       : Noninterlaced
Palette                         : (Binary data 768 bytes, use -b option to extract)
Transparency                    : (Binary data 256 bytes, use -b option to extract)
Pixels Per Unit X               : 11811
Pixels Per Unit Y               : 11811
Pixel Units                     : meters
Comment                         : deadface{b00m_h34Dsh0TTT}
Image Size                      : 512x512
Megapixels                      : 0.262
andra@LAPTOP-S4SA7HCK:/mnt/c/users/andra/downloads/headshot (1)$
```

Flag

deadface{b00m_h34Dsh0TTT}

OSINT

[50 pts] Car Crash

by @RP-01?

DEADFACE has been researching companies connected to one of their latest targets. Among the files recovered was a photo of a traffic accident involving a commercial truck.

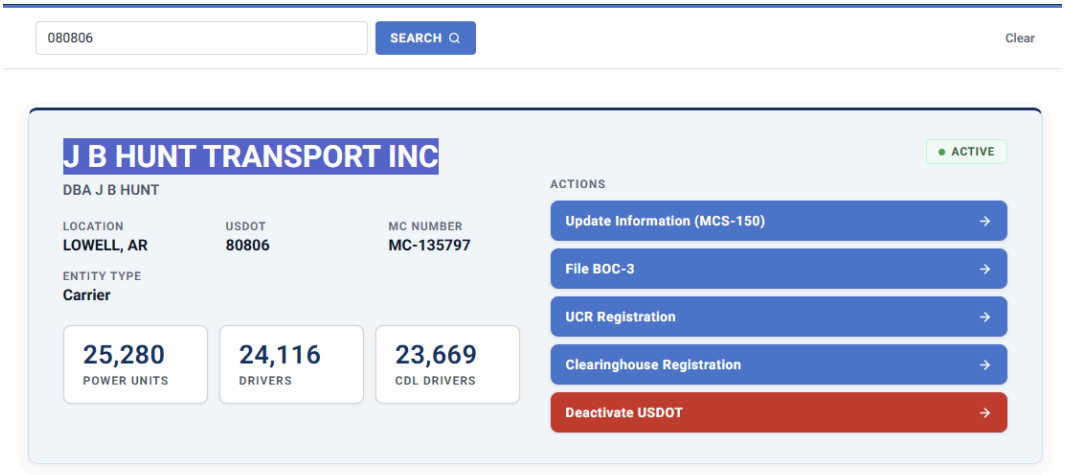
We believe the truck may identify a company DEADFACE has taken an interest in. Determine which company owns the truck and when that company was founded.

Given a picture of a truck crash, the task is to find the truck company and date found.

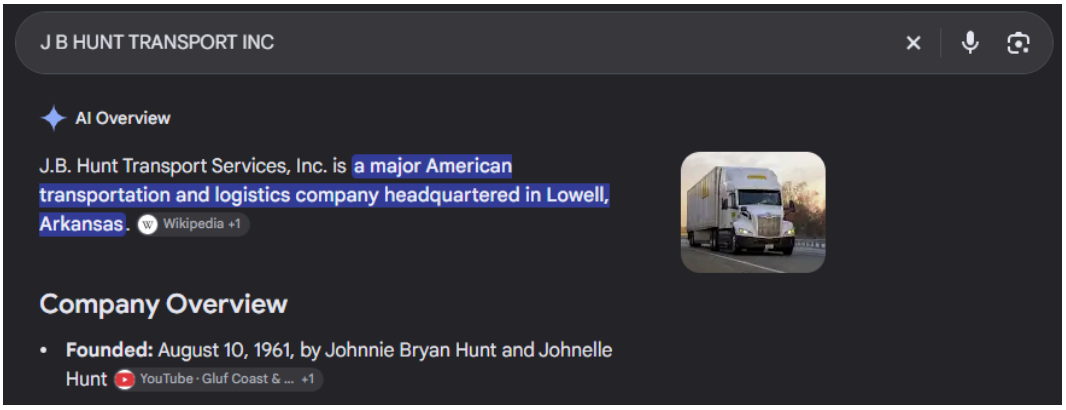


The truck has USDOT: 080806 on it and I looked up USDOT lookup

I found dotmcs.com and put the number in and the truck belonged to J B HUNT TRANSPORT INC



Just by searching on Google, the date was found



Flag

deadface{08_10_1961}

Traffic Analysis

[25 pts] Data Go Brrr

Our client wants to know what is happening on their network. Data is leaving the network and they have limited it down to a small segment of traffic. Can you find the flag associated with the data being exfiltrated?

Used help for this

Flag

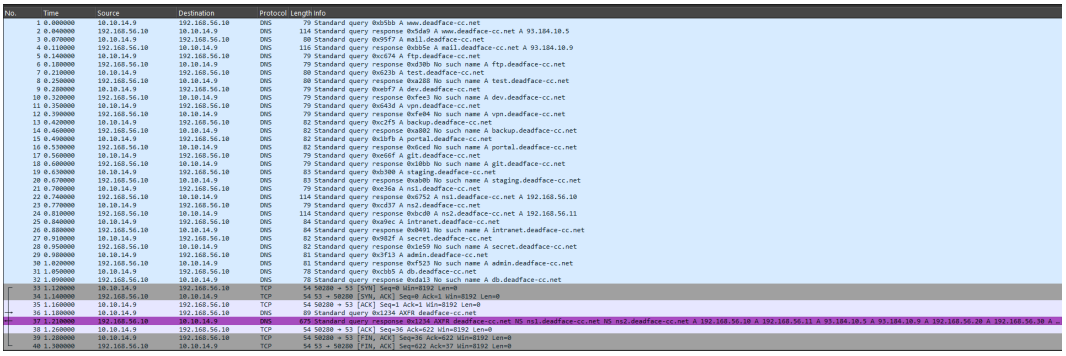
deadface{icmp_3xfil_wh3n_th3y_least_susp3ct}

[50 pts] Twilight Zone Transfer

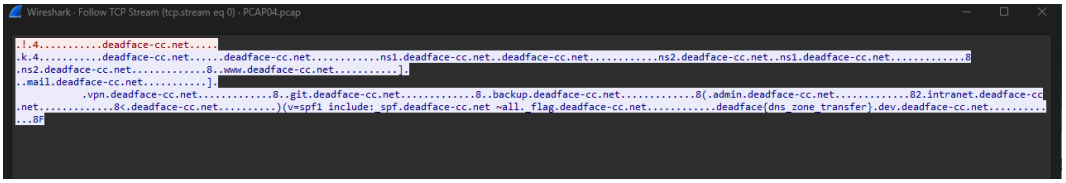
A misconfigured DNS server allowed an unauthorized zone transfer (AXFR). The attacker enumerated hostnames, then pulled the ENTIRE zone in one request. The capture already contains that transfer, find it and read the records.

Submit the flag with the dog's name as: deadface{flag-text}

Given a pcap file, I used Wireshark and looked at the pakcets. There is 1 DNS that I find a little different so I took a glance at it and followed the TCP stream. Did that because I’m used to doing that when given a pcap file.



There is a piece of text that looks like a flag but the chall desc said the name of a dog where the flag doesn’t look like a dog name at all, dns_zone_transfer



I tried to submit the flag and it was correct after all

Flag

deadface{dns_zone_transfer}

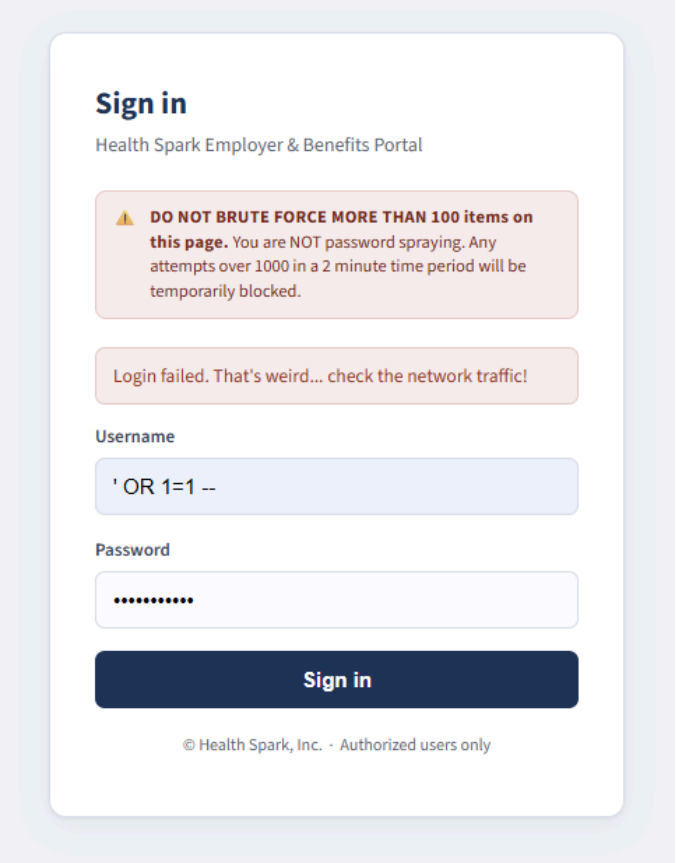
Web

[26 pts] Doctor Appointment

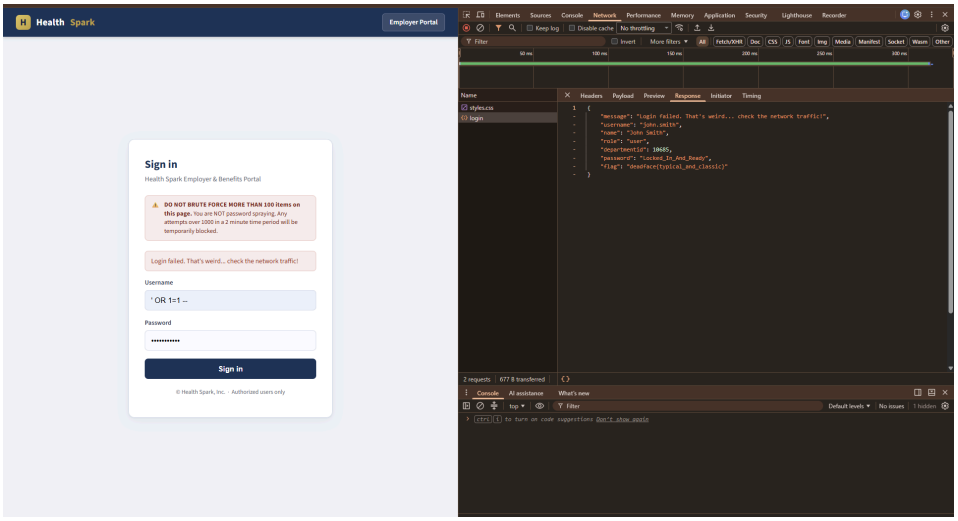
by @RP-01?

Web applications are tricky these days and we are seeing an influx of vibe coded platforms. Well, time to put your black hat on and see if you can gain access to this website. Don't just brute force a massive dictionary. Take a look at GhostTown for potential resources to gain access.

Given a website at the login page, the first instinct was to do SQLi and it didn't work but the error message said Login failed. That's weird... check the network traffic!



I inspected the page and went to Network, put SQLi creds and the flag was there



Flag

deadface{typical_and_classic}